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# 3Q 2026 TUGON NG MASA (TNM) SURVEY:
# Report to Media on:

## Voting Preference for the 2028 Senatorial Elections

**October 19, 2026**

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We are delighted to share some key findings from the **Tugon ng Masa (TNM)** nationwide survey, an independent and non-partisan poll conducted regularly by OCTA RESEARCH. The non-commissioned results presented here focus on current voting preferences in a **hypothetical 2028 senatorial election**. These survey results are released as a public service by OCTA RESEARCH.

The survey fieldwork was conducted from **September 28 to October 4, 2026**, using face-to-face interviews. One thousand two hundred (1,200) male and female probability respondents aged 18 and above were interviewed for the study. This survey has a **±3%** margin of error at a 95% confidence level. Subnational estimates for the geographic areas covered in the survey have the following margins of error at a 95% confidence level: **±6%** for NCR, Balance Luzon, Visayas, and Mindanao.

To download the complete presentation of the survey results and technical details, please visit the OCTA webpage at https://www.octaresearch.com or the FB page at https://www.facebook.com/OCTAResearch.

For any clarifications or questions about the TNM survey, kindly contact OCTA Research Fellows Mr. Ranjit Rye or Mr. Guido David via email at octaresearchphilippines@gmail.com.

Thank you for assisting us in disseminating to the public these survey results.

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# Tulfo, Padilla, Cayetano, and Sotto Locked in Four-Way Statistical Tie for First Place in OCTA's Early 2028 Senatorial Race Survey

***Raffy Tulfo, Robin Padilla, Alan Peter Cayetano, and Vico Sotto share the first-to-fourth rank range in the 3Q 2026 Tugon ng Masa survey; Grace Poe and Loren Legarda follow, while several others remain in contention for the remaining slots in the top 12.***

## Context

The Q3 2026 Tugon ng Masa (TNM) survey was conducted from September 28 to October 4, 2026, through face-to-face interviews with 1,200 respondents aged 18 and above nationwide. The survey employed probability-based sampling and has a ±3 percentage-point margin of error at the 95% confidence level.

Respondents were presented with a hypothetical list of prospective candidates and were asked the question: *I have here a list of names that may run in the May 2028 elections. If the May 2028 elections will be held today, who will you likely vote for as SENATOR? You may choose up to 12 names.* The exercise is hypothetical: the official filing of candidacies is still more than a year away, the final field of candidates has not been determined, and several individuals included in the survey may ultimately decide not to run.

Some individuals initially considered for inclusion in the OCTA survey were removed from the list at their request. In presenting the results, names receiving less than 1% were also excluded from the published list. These exclusions should be considered when interpreting the distribution of preferences and do not imply that the published names constitute the complete or final field of potential candidates.

The findings should not be interpreted as a forecast of the 2028 senatorial election. They provide only a snapshot of voter preferences during the September 28 to October 4, 2026 fieldwork period. Preferences may change substantially as political alignments, candidacies, campaign conditions, public issues, and voter information evolve. Rank ranges are reported because candidates with close percentages may be statistically tied within the survey's margin of error.

## Executive Summary

Results of the Q3 2026 Tugon ng Masa nationwide survey show Raffy Tulfo (47%), Robin Padilla (45%), Alan Peter Cayetano (44%), and Vico Sotto (42%) in a statistical tie at the top of the hypothetical 2028 senatorial preference list, with each sharing a rank range of first to fourth. Grace Poe followed with 36%, ranking fifth to sixth, while Loren Legarda registered 31%.

Abby Binay (29%), Mark Lapid (28%), and Francis “Chiz” Escudero (27%) formed the next group, followed by Sonny Angara and Manny Pacquiao (both 25%), Ben Tulfo (23%), and Jinggoy Estrada (22%), all of whom were positioned within or near the preliminary top 12.

Because many estimates are separated by only a few percentage points, the rankings should be interpreted using the reported rank ranges rather than as fixed placements. The results reflect preferences only at the time of the survey and should not be treated as predictions of candidacy, campaign performance, or the final election outcome.

## Report Highlights

### 1. Four Prospective Candidates Are Statistically Tied at the Top

Raffy Tulfo registered the highest voting preference at 47%, followed by Robin Padilla (45%), Alan Peter Cayetano (44%), and Vico Sotto (42%). The four share a rank range of first to fourth, indicating that their relative order cannot be treated as statistically fixed. Grace Poe (36%) and Loren Legarda (31%) followed, with rank ranges of fifth to sixth and fifth to ninth, respectively.

### 2. Several Prospective Candidates Are Competitive for the Remaining Top-12 Positions

Abby Binay received 29%, followed by Mark Lapid at 28% and Francis “Chiz” Escudero at 27%. Sonny Angara and Manny Pacquiao each registered 25%, while Ben Tulfo received 23% and Jinggoy Estrada 22%. Their overlapping rank ranges show that several prospective candidates remain competitive for positions within the preliminary top 12. Aquilino “Koko” Pimentel III and Salvador “Sal” Panelo (both 20%), Mark Villar (19%), and Gringo Honasan and Francis “Tol” Tolentino (both 18%) also remained within the broad statistical range covering the last available slots. These are not definitive placements, since sampling error and future changes in the prospective candidate field may alter the rankings.

### 3. Compared with the Q2 2026 Survey

In the Q2 2026 TNM survey (fieldwork July 4–11, 2026), Robin Padilla led at 53.9% and Raffy Tulfo followed at 47.4%. In Q3, Tulfo’s figure is essentially unchanged at 47%, while Padilla registered 45%. Alan Peter Cayetano (45.4% to 44%) and Vico Sotto (42.0% to 42%) were also largely steady, whereas Grace Poe (44.5% to 36%), Loren Legarda (39.0% to 31%), and Manny Pacquiao (34.5% to 25%) registered lower figures. Sonny Angara (19.2% to 25%) and Francis “Chiz” Escudero (23.2% to 27%) registered higher figures. Because the list of names presented to respondents differed between rounds, quarter-on-quarter comparisons should be made with caution.

### 4. Results Are a Hypothetical Snapshot, Not an Election Forecast

The survey captures voter preferences under a specific hypothetical list during the September 28 to October 4, 2026 fieldwork period. Some names were removed from the list at their request, and prospective candidates receiving less than 1% were omitted from the published results. The findings therefore should not be read as a complete candidate lineup, a prediction of who will file a candidacy, or a forecast of the 2028 senatorial election.

**Table 1**
**Voting Preference for the 2028 Senatorial Elections**
September 28 – October 4, 2026 / Philippines
(in Percent)

| Base: Total Interviews | | |
|---|---|---|
| | Rank | Voting For |
| TULFO, RAFFY | 1 - 4 | 47 |
| PADILLA, ROBIN | 1 - 4 | 45 |
| CAYETANO, ALAN PETER | 1 - 4 | 44 |
| SOTTO, VICO | 1 - 4 | 42 |
| POE, GRACE | 5 - 6 | 36 |
| LEGARDA, LOREN | 5 - 9 | 31 |
| BINAY, ABBY | 6 - 11 | 29 |
| LAPID, MARK | 6 - 12 | 28 |
| ESCUDERO, FRANCIS “CHIZ” | 6 - 13 | 27 |
| ANGARA, SONNY | 7 - 15 | 25 |
| PACQUIAO, MANNY | 7 - 15 | 25 |
| TULFO, BEN | 8 - 18 | 23 |
| ESTRADA, JINGGOY | 9 - 18 | 22 |
| PIMENTEL III, AQUILINO “KOKO” | 10 - 26 | 20 |
| PANELO, SALVADOR “SAL” | 10 - 26 | 20 |
| VILLAR, MARK | 12 - 26 | 19 |
| HONASAN, GRINGO | 12 - 27 | 18 |
| TOLENTINO, FRANCIS “TOL” | 12 - 27 | 18 |
| REVILLAME, WILLIE | 14 - 29 | 16 |
| ABALOS, BENHUR | 14 - 29 | 16 |
| BOSITA, BONIFACIO | 14 - 29 | 16 |
| EJERCITO, JV | 14 - 29 | 16 |
| TEODORO, GIBO | 14 - 29 | 16 |
| REVILLA, BONG | 14 - 31 | 15 |
| BARBERS, ROBERT “ACE” | 14 - 31 | 15 |
| DRILON, FRANKLIN | 14 - 31 | 15 |
| SALVADOR, PHILIP | 17 - 34 | 13 |
| DE LIMA, LEILA | 19 - 35 | 12 |
| BONDOC, JIMMY | 19 - 35 | 12 |
| TRILLANES, ANTONIO | 24 - 42 | 10 |
| DIOKNO, CHEL | 24 - 42 | 10 |
| RECTO, RALPH | 27 - 44 | 9 |
| GORDON, RICHARD | 27 - 44 | 8 |
| ZAMORA, FRANCIS | 27 - 44 | 8 |
| BELMONTE, JOY | 28 - 45 | 7 |
| DE LEON, ATTY. DINO | 30 - 46 | 6 |
| DIZON, VINCE | 30 - 46 | 5 |
| CASTRO, ATTY. CLAIRE | 30 - 46 | 5 |
| RIDON, TERRY | 30 - 46 | 5 |
| ADIONG, ZIA ALONTO | 30 - 46 | 5 |
| MENDOZA, HEIDI | 30 - 46 | 5 |
| GREGORIO, PATRICK “PATO” | 30 - 46 | 5 |
| MAGALONG, BENJAMIN | 32 - 46 | 4 |
| TARRIELA, JAY | 32 - 46 | 4 |

*Red line: names whose rank range begins at 12th or better.*

# TNM Q3-2026 TECHNICAL DETAILS

## I. LOCATION

The survey was conducted nationwide from September 28 – October 4, 2026

| | |
|---|---|
| National Capital Region (NCR) | September 28 – October 4, 2026 |
| Balance Luzon | September 28 – October 4, 2026 |
| Visayas | September 28 – October 4, 2026 |
| Mindanao | September 28 – October 4, 2026 |

## II. RESPONDENT AND SAMPLE SIZE

One thousand two hundred (1,200) male and female probability respondents aged 18 years and above from socioeconomic classes ABCDE were interviewed for the study.

The sample was distributed as follows:

| | URBAN | RURAL |
|---|---|---|
| National Capital Region (NCR) | 300 | |
| Balance Luzon | 80 | 220 |
| *North Luzon* | *20* | *125* |
| *South Luzon* | *60* | *95* |
| Visayas | 100 | 200 |
| Mindanao | 105 | 195 |

## III. SAMPLING DESIGN

Sample sizes and Error Margins

Below is the distribution of the sample by area and the corresponding error margin at the 95% confidence level.

| AREA | SAMPLE SIZE | ERROR MARGIN |
|---|---|---|
| **TOTAL PHILIPPINES** | **1,200** | **±3%** |
| **National Capital Region** | **300** | **±6%** |
| **North/Central Luzon** | **145** | **±8%** |
| Cordillera Administrative Region | 10 | ±31% |
| Region I | 35 | ±17% |
| Region II | 25 | ±20% |
| Region III | 75 | ±11% |
| **Southern Luzon** | **155** | **±8%** |
| Region IV-A | 100 | ±10% |
| MIMAROPA Region | 20 | ±22% |
| Region V | 35 | ±17% |
| **Visayas** | **300** | **±6%** |
| Region VI | 80 | ±11% |
| Region VII | 95 | ±10% |
| Region VIII | 65 | ±12% |
| NIR (Negros Island Region) | 60 | ±13% |

| Mindanao | 300 | ±6% |
|---|---|---|
| Region IX | 55 | ±13% |
| Region X | 60 | ±13% |
| Region XI | 60 | ±13% |
| Region XII | 50 | ±14% |
| CARAGA | 30 | ±18% |
| BARMM | 45 | ±15% |

## IV. SAMPLING SCHEME

The number of sample barangays was distributed among the 18 regions proportional to population size. In each sample barangay, five (5) probability respondents were selected.

| AREA | SAMPLE BARANGAYS | PROBABILITY RESPONDENTS |
|---|---|---|
| **TOTAL PHILIPPINES** | **240** | **1,200** |
| **National Capital Region** | **60** | **300** |
| **North/Central Luzon** | **29** | **145** |
| Cordillera Administrative Region | 2 | 10 |
| Region I | 7 | 35 |
| Region II | 5 | 25 |
| Region III | 15 | 75 |
| **Southern Luzon** | **31** | **155** |
| Region IV-A | 20 | 100 |
| MIMAROPA Region | 4 | 20 |
| Region V | 7 | 35 |
| **Visayas** | **60** | **300** |
| Region VI | 16 | 80 |
| Region VII | 19 | 95 |
| Region VIII | 13 | 65 |
| NIR (Negros Island Region) | 12 | 60 |
| **Mindanao** | **60** | **300** |
| Region IX | 11 | 55 |
| Region X | 12 | 60 |
| Region XI | 12 | 60 |
| Region XII | 10 | 50 |
| CARAGA | 6 | 30 |
| BARMM | 9 | 45 |

***For the National Capital Region:***

- Stage 1: Selection of Sample Barangays – Sixty (60) barangays were distributed among the 17 cities and municipalities in such a way that each city/ municipality was assigned a number of barangays that is roughly proportional to its population size. An additional provision was that each city/municipality must have at least one sample barangay. Barangays were randomly selected without replacement from within each city/municipality.
- Stage 2: Selection of Sample Households – In each sample barangay, interval sampling was used to draw 5 sample households. A starting street corner was drawn at random. The first sample household was randomly selected from the households nearest to the starting street corner. Subsequently, every 6th household was sampled.
- Stage 3: Selection of the Sample Adult – In each selected household, a respondent was randomly chosen from among household members who were 18 years of age and older, using a probability selection table. To ensure that half of the respondents were male and half were female, only male family members were pre-listed in the probability selection table of odd-numbered questionnaires while only female members were pre-listed for even-numbered questionnaires. In cases where there was no qualified respondent of a given gender, the interval sampling of households was continued until five sample respondents were identified.

*For the rest of the Philippines:*

- Stage 1: Allocation of sample barangays to Regions – The number of barangays allocated to each region was proportional to population size.
- Stage 2: Allocation and Selection of Sample Cities/Municipalities to Regions – Within each region, sample cities/municipalities were allocated in proportion to household population size. Sample cities/municipalities were selected without replacement and with probability proportional to household population size.
- Stage 3: Selection of Sample Barangays – Once the cities/municipalities had been selected, the allocated number of barangays were distributed among the sample cities/municipalities in such a way that each city/municipality was assigned a number of barangays roughly proportional to its household population size. However, it was ensured that each city/municipality would be assigned at least one sample barangay. Sample barangays within each sample city/municipality were randomly selected without replacement.
- Stage 4: Selection of Sample Households – Within each sample barangay, five households were selected through interval sampling. In sample urban barangays, a random corner was identified, a random start generated, and the sampling interval used was five. In rural barangays, the designated starting point could be a school, the barangay captain's house, a church/ chapel, or a barangay/municipal hall and the interval was one.
- Stage 5: Selection of the Sample Adult – In each selected household, a respondent was randomly chosen from among household members who were 18 years of age and older, using a probability selection table. To ensure that half of the respondents were male and half were female, only male family members were pre-listed in the probability selection table of odd-numbered questionnaires while only female members were pre-listed for even-numbered questionnaires. In cases where there was no qualified respondent of a given gender, the interval sampling of households was continued until five sample respondents were identified.

## V. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

*Setting-up*

- The survey questionnaire was developed by OCTA Research and finalized by the Project Manager. It was prepared in Filipino with a corresponding English translation. The questionnaire was also translated into the following languages (Bicol, Cebuano, Ilocano, Ilonggo) for use in different areas covered in the survey.
- Field interviewers engaged for the study underwent extensive training prior to deployment. The objectives of the study, the questionnaire, interview techniques and interval sampling for the fieldwork coverage were discussed in detail during the training. The training was conducted face to face and online in central locations across the country namely Quezon City, Cebu City, Iloilo City, Zamboanga City and Davao City.

*Data Gathering and Supervision*

- Field Supervisors reporting to the Field Manager monitored the data gathering for the study full-time. They observed (10% of total interviews), followed-up and conducted surprise checks on the field interviewers. They also ensured that field logistics were received promptly and administered properly.
- Spot checks were conducted on 25% of the interviews not observed by the field supervisors at various stages of the fieldwork.
- During spot-checking, the unsupervised interviews were re-interviewed/back-checked. If serious errors persisted after spot-checking, the original interviews were invalidated and respondents were re-interviewed. An error was considered serious if there was evidence of dishonest recording of responses or if there was a serious misinterpretation of the study that resulted in incorrect information.
- If the probability respondent was not available during the initial visit, a second visit was scheduled within the same day. In cases where the qualified respondent was still not available or when the door was still locked after 2 valid callbacks, substitute interview was conducted.
- Substitutes were required to have the same economic class, age group, working status and gender from the same area as the original respondent.

*Digital Data Capture, Instrument Validation, and Processing*

- SurveyToGo software was used for direct Computer-Assisted Personal Interviewing (CAPI). Field interviewers encoded responses in real time via tablets and mobile smartphones using a programmed questionnaire that matched the final approved paper questionnaire (question wording, response options, skips, constraints, and validations). Prior to field deployment, the Data Processing Manager, together with the Field Director, conducted a structured validation of the script to confirm completeness, logical flow, and accuracy of programmed checks (e.g., required fields, range limits, and skip patterns).
- For post-interview quality control and back-checking, 18% of the interviews completed were reviewed for:
    - Area Coverage – confirmation of correct interview location using the recorded GPS coordinates
    - Interview integrity – review of the audio recording of the actual interviews and photo attachments to confirm that the interview was conducted as reported and in compliance with the standard interview protocols
    - Data accuracy – independent re-encoding of responses based on the recorded interviews, followed by cross-validation against the SurveyToGo captured dataset.
- Preliminary data tables were generated to check the quality of data encoding. Specifically, the encoded data was checked for accuracy of variable labels, variable values, and completeness and consistency of data entries.